



Muncie Ethics Commission - July 8, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XwwVsXpkaHQ
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Target Category	muncie_city_ethics

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Municipal Meeting Report: City of Muncie Ethics Commission

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting to order **00:00:11** to review previous minutes, address pending ethics complaints, and discuss updates on the transparency portal.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Susan Dylan, Sandra Whitaker, Jim Lo, Frank Scott, Chip Taylor, and Brandon Murphy [00:00:01 - 00:00:07].
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Susan Dylan (Chair).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None noted in the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the April 8th meeting were motioned, seconded, and approved by voice vote [00:00:37 – 00:00:49].

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:04:26 Ethics Complaint Review: Complaint EC26-01

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission / Chair Susan Dylan.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The commission reviewed four complaints following a prior executive session on June 24th. For the first complaint of the year (EC26-01), the commission discussed the necessity of further investigation.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved a motion to stay proceedings and initiate an investigation because additional investigation is necessary (Code 42.01D6). Passed by roll call vote (5-0: Susan Dylan, yes; Sandra Whitaker, yes; Jim Lo, yes; Frank Scott, yes; Chip Taylor, yes) [00:04:53 – 00:05:50].
- **Investigating Assignment & Scope:** Commissioners Chip Taylor and Frank Scott were appointed to lead the investigation [00:12:24](#). The board approved the scope of investigation and authorization of subpoenas (permitting interviews with the complainant, witnesses, and respondent, verifying documents, and compelling production of documents/witnesses per sections 41.04(7) and 41.04(8) of the Muncie Ethics Code) by voice vote [00:13:17 – 00:14:52].

00:08:03 Ethics Complaint Review: Complaint EC26-02

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The commission addressed complaint EC26-02. After initial confusion regarding complaint numbering, a motion was brought forward to dismiss the complaint based on an assessment of facts.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved a motion to dismiss because the complaint does not allege sufficient facts to determine whether there is a violation of the code of ethics (Code 42.01D4). Passed by roll call vote (5-0) [00:08:43 – 00:09:04].

00:09:09 Ethics Complaint Review: Complaint EC26-03

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The commission reviewed complaint EC26-03.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved a motion to dismiss because the complaint does not allege sufficient facts to determine whether there is a violation of the code of ethics (Code 42.01D4). Passed by roll call vote (5-0) [00:09:25 – 00:09:56].

00:09:58 Ethics Complaint Review: Complaint EC26-04

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ethics Commission.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The commission reviewed complaint EC26-04.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved a motion to dismiss because the allegations have been handled appropriately by the appropriate public official and/or department of the city

(Code 42.01D2). Passed by roll call vote (5-0) [00:10:21 – 00:10:59].

00:15:10 Old Business: Transparency Portal Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chip Taylor & Susan Dylan.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Commissioners provided an update on the municipal transparency portal, established in collaboration with City Clerk Lacey and city department heads. The portal's focus expanded starting May 1st to include complete, fully-signed contracts and supplemental supporting documentation (such as purchase invoices from police and fire departments). Department heads were reported to be highly cooperative during recent check-ins at City Hall. Commissioners noted that utilizing the portal can help reduce open-records request burdens by making public purchasing and contract data easily accessible.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:23:55 Unnamed Resident:** Asked for clarification regarding code citation numbers and how they connect to the ethics code and complaint actions. Commissioners explained that citations directly reflect the explicit statutory actions available under the Muncie Ethics Ordinance, and noted that the full code text is published online via the transparency portal.
 - **00:26:39 Unnamed Resident:** Inquired about the timeline and criteria for when ethics investigations and alleged code violations become public record, and how matters proceed following an investigation. Legal counsel and commissioners clarified that under the ordinance, details regarding active investigations remain confidential until the investigative report is formally received and acted upon by the commission.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Temporary legal counsel noted they are stepping in solely for complaint EC26-01 due to a potential conflict of interest involving regular city attorneys **00:30:53**.
 - The next regularly scheduled quarterly meeting is set for **August 12th at 5:30 PM 00:35:01**, pending any adjustments called by investigative timelines.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was concluded with a motion to adjourn, approved by voice vote [00:35:39 – 00:35:48].
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